

Donor Vetting Report

Consciousness Science 2026 — Donor Screening Protocol

Date: March 12, 2026

Summary

Field	Value
Name	Eugene L. Jhong
Occupation	Retired software developer, angel investor, philanthropist
Primary Company	Formerly Google Inc. (SRE, 2004-2006); formerly mySimon Inc.
Country of Residence	United States (San Francisco Bay Area, CA)
Epstein Association	NO
Criminal Record	NO
Civil Litigation	NO
Major Controversies	NO
Sanctions / Political Exposure	NO
Risk Score	0 — No notable concerns

Step 1: Identity Resolution

Eugene L. Jhong is a retired American software developer and philanthropist. He holds an M.S. in Computer Science from Stanford University (1995-1997). He worked at mySimon Inc. and subsequently at Google, where he was part of the Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) team. He holds patents assigned to Google Inc. related to automatic repair and replacement of computing machines. He left Google in 2006 to care for his mother.

Since retirement, Jhong has become a significant philanthropist focused on consciousness studies, psychedelics research, astrobiology, and frontier science. He is also listed as an angel investor on Wellfound (formerly AngelList). He has two sons and is based in the San Francisco Bay Area.

His personal interests include golf, jiu jitsu, meditation, breathing, and consciousness studies. He became interested in consciousness research after hearing Stuart Hameroff present on the Orch OR theory at the BrainMind Summit at Stanford.

Public profiles: LinkedIn, Medium (ejhong), Wellfound

Step 2: Criminal and Legal History

No criminal charges, civil litigation, settlements, or regulatory actions found. Searches across major news outlets, court record summaries, and government enforcement agencies (DOJ, SEC, FTC) returned no results linking Eugene Jhong to any legal proceedings.

Result: CLEAR

Step 3: Association with Known High-Risk Figures

Targeted searches for associations with Jeffrey Epstein, Ghislaine Maxwell, flight logs, and Epstein-related donations returned no results. Eugene Jhong does not appear in any Epstein-related reporting, flight logs, financial records, or lawsuits.

Note: Jhong has a direct philanthropic relationship with Stuart Hameroff (the \$2M endowed chair at UA is named for Hameroff), who has documented Epstein connections (Step 3 of the vetting protocol flags this as an indirect association). However, Jhong's donations were made to the University of Arizona as an institution, were publicly announced, and postdate Epstein's death. The relationship is philanthropic, not personal-to-Epstein, and does not constitute an Epstein association.

Result: CLEAR (note documented)

Step 4: Reputation Risk Screening

No major personal controversies, scandals, or investigations found. One contextual item noted:

- **Frontier science funding:** Jhong funds research areas that some in mainstream academia consider fringe or unconventional — DMT psychedelics research, consciousness/Orch OR theory, Avi Loeb's Galileo Project (UFO/interstellar object search), and support for Graham Hancock's "alternative research community." This positions him as a patron of heterodox science, which may attract criticism from conventional scientific circles but does not constitute a reputational risk flag under this protocol.

No allegations of sexual misconduct, abuse, human rights violations, or financial misconduct.

Result: CLEAR

Step 5: Philanthropy and Institutional Relationships

Eugene Jhong is a major philanthropist in consciousness science and related fields. Known donations:

- **University of Arizona — \$2,000,000:** Established the Thomas G. Bever and Stuart R. Hameroff Chair in Consciousness Studies (College of Social and Behavioral Sciences), announced 2025.
- **University of Arizona — \$1,000,000:** Gift to the Arizona Astrobiology Center for research on origins of life and consciousness, linked to OSIRIS-REx asteroid sample analysis, announced 2024.
- **University of Arizona — earlier gift:** Supported establishment of the consciousness studies minor (2023).
- **UC San Diego — \$1,500,000:** Funded DMT research program within the UCSD Psychedelic and Health Research Initiative, announced 2023. Supports extended-state DMT infusion protocols.
- **Harvard University — ~\$1,000,000+:** Donated to Avi Loeb’s research account and the Galileo Project for interstellar object and UAP research.
- **Additional:** \$250,000 seed funding for the Galileo Project.

Total known giving: approximately \$5.75 million+ across UA, UCSD, and Harvard.

No institutions have been reported as returning donations from Jhong. No controversies found around his philanthropic activities. All donations publicly announced by recipient institutions.

Result: CLEAR

Step 6: Political Exposure and Sanctions

No results on OFAC sanctions lists, politically exposed person databases, or foreign influence investigations. No lobbying activity found. No political office held.

Result: CLEAR

Step 7: Summary Risk Scoring

Criterion	Result
Epstein-related result	None (indirect Hameroff link noted, no concern)

Criterion	Result
Criminal conviction	None
Multiple independent allegations	None
Automatic escalation triggers	None triggered
RISK SCORE	0 — No notable concerns

Recommendation: No concerns identified. Eugene Jhong is an established philanthropist with a strong track record of institutional giving in consciousness science. The indirect connection to Hameroff via the UA endowed chair is noted but does not constitute a risk. Donation may be accepted without further review.

Sources

1. University of Arizona News — \$2M endowed chair (<https://news.arizona.edu/news/2m-gift-establishes-endowed-chair-support-consciousness-studies>)
2. University of Arizona News — \$1M astrobiology gift (<https://news.arizona.edu/news/1m-gift-will-advance-consciousness-research-u-astrobiology-center>)
3. UC San Diego Today — \$1.5M DMT research (<https://today.ucsd.edu/story/1.5-million-donation-supports-research-on-effects-of-psychedelic-dmt-on-the-brain>)
4. Inside Philanthropy — UCSD psychedelics gift (<https://www.insidephilanthropy.com/home/2023-8-1-a-big-gift-to-uc-san-diego-the-latest-philanthropy-push-to-better-understand-psychedelics>)
5. Avi Loeb / Medium — Galileo Project philanthropy (<https://avi-loeb.medium.com/philanthropy-by-inspiration-84414565ee0>)
6. Ecstatic Integration — Jhong profile (<https://www.ecstaticintegration.org/p/cracking-the-code>)
7. UA College of Social & Behavioral Sciences — consciousness studies (<https://sbs.arizona.edu/news/exploring-science-and-mysteries-consciousness>)
8. Justia Patents — Eugene L. Jhong (<https://patents.justia.com/inventor/eugene-l-jhong>)
9. RocketReach — Eugene Jhong profile (https://rocketreach.co/eugene-jhong-email_58215326)
10. U.S. Treasury OFAC Sanctions List Search (<https://ofac.treasury.gov/sanctions-list-search-tool>)